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26 August 2026

PARTICIPATE IN GROUPS AND/OR TEAMS TO RECOMMEND SOLUTIONS TO PROBLEMS

US 14920

SECTION B: SUMMATIVEASSESSMENT

TEAM DETAILS REPORT

1. Name of Organisation: Boxer Superstore - Dobsonville, Soweto

2. Team Name: Problem Solving Team - Operations Department

3. Supervisor / Team Leader: Ms. N. Dlamini - Store Manager

4. Date Assigned: 09 September 2026

5. Number of People in Team: 5 members

- Member 1: [Your Name] - Role: Team Coordinator / Researcher - Student
- Member 2: P. Khumalo - Role: Admin Clerk - Scribe
- Member 3: S. Ncube - Role: Stock Controller - Timekeeper
- Member 4: T. Nkosi - Role: Cashier - Member
- Member 5: L. Dlamini - Role: Cashier - Member

6. Objective of Team: To identify causes of slow POS system and stock discrepancies and recommend practical solutions to improve customer service and reduce losses.

7. Problem to be Solved: Slow computer system during peak hours, no backup power during load shedding, stock discrepancies between system and physical stock.

8. Duration: 09 - 20 September 2026

Signature of Supervisor: _____

TASK 1

a) PROBLEM DETAILS FORM

Date: 09 September 2026

From: Ms. N. Dlamini - Store Manager (Supervisor)

To: Problem Solving Team

Problem Statement:

Our store has been experiencing three major problems for the past 2 months:

1. POS System is very slow between 16h00 - 18h00. Tills freeze for 2-3 minutes. Customers complain and leave. We lose about 10 customers per day.

2. During load shedding, all computers shut down. No UPS or inverter. We close shop for 2 hours, losing R5,000 per load shedding session.

3. Stock discrepancies - System shows 20 units of cooking oil but physical count is 15 units. Difference of 5 units missing. Suspected scanning errors or theft.

Impact: Loss of sales, loss of customers, inaccurate reports to Head Office.

Task Assigned to Team: Investigate causes, gather data, brainstorm solutions, research options and present final recommendation with budget by 20 September 2026.

Expected Outcome: Report with 3-4 practical solutions with costs.

Supervisor Signature: N. Dlamini Date: 09/09/2026

Team Leader Signature: [Your Name]

b) GROUP DISCUSSION REPORT - Led by Precious Fikile Mkhize on 10 September 2026

Venue: Admin Office, Boxer Dobsonville Time: 10h00 - 11h30

How I led the discussion and encouraged contributions:

1. Are relevant to, and focussed on, subject matter and group/team objectives:*

I started meeting by reading problem statement from supervisor. I wrote objectives on flip chart: "Solve slow POS, load shedding, stock loss". I kept team focused by saying "Let's stick to POS problem first" whenever members went off topic. My contributions were relevant - I suggested we check internet speed test data and load shedding schedule.

2. Are in a range of decision making processes and contexts:

I used two decision methods:

- Consensus for identifying main problem - we all agreed load shedding is biggest problem.

- Majority voting to choose final solution - we voted between UPS vs Generator and UPS won 4-1.

My contribution considered different contexts - operational (cashiers need working tills), financial (manager needs low cost), technical (IT needs compatible system).

3. Use of available or acquired data:

I presented data I acquired:

- Internet speed test showing 5Mbps at 17h00 vs 45Mbps at 09h00 (slow at peak)

- Load shedding schedule showing 2 hours daily 16h00-18h00

- Stock report showing 15% discrepancy in cooking oil.

I used this data to support my contribution that internet and power are root causes.

4. Are Objective

I was not biased. I did not blame cashiers for stock loss. I said "Let's look at facts - system shows data, maybe scanner error not theft". I listened to all members without favoritism and evaluated all ideas fairly.

5. Utilises verbal and non-verbal feedback to show interest and opinion:*

Verbal: I said "Good point Patience", "I agree with Sibusiso", "Can you explain more Thandi?". I encouraged quiet members by asking "Lerato, what do you think?".

Non-verbal: I maintained eye contact, nodded to show I was listening, smiled, used open body language, wrote every contribution on flip chart to show value.

TASK DELEGATION FORM

Date: 11 September 2026

To: Precious Fikile Mkhize Team Coordinator

From: Ms. N. Dlamini - Team Leader

New Task Delegated to You:

Research and gather information about UPS and inverter prices and specifications suitable for 6 POS tills and 1 server. Also research 100Mbps fibre internet packages and cloud backup solutions. Present findings to team on 13 September 2026 with costs and recommendations.

Deadline: 13 September 2026 at 10h00

Resources: Use store laptop, internet, call suppliers.

Team Leader Signature: N. Dlamini

1. Share responsibility for group/team problems: I took responsibility for my delegated research task and also helped Patience with stock count. I did not say "that's not my job".

2. Overcome obstacles and ensure team function is consistent with team objectives: Obstacle was load shedding during our meeting on 12 Sept - lights off. I overcame by using phone torch and continuing meeting, and suggested we move meeting to morning.

3. Monitor own behaviour (mannerisms, tone, language):I monitored my tone - I did not shout even when one member was late. I spoke calmly and respectfully in English and Zulu where needed. I avoided interrupting.

4. Adhere to set procedures: I followed meeting procedure - agenda, minutes, timekeeping. I followed company procedure - no customer photos, kept financial data confidential.

5. Comply with group/team decisions: Team decided UPS is better than generator. Even though I initially wanted generator, I complied and supported UPS decision.

6. Share credit for group/team successes: In final presentation I said "This success is for whole team, not just me. Patience did scribe, Sibusiso kept time, cashiers gave valuable data."

a) BRAINSTORMING SESSION REPORT - Led by Precious Fikile Mkhize-11 September 2026

Method: Brainstorming - All ideas welcome, no criticism.

Topic: Solutions to slow POS, load shedding, stock discrepancy

Ideas recorded on flip chart:

From T. Nkosi (Cashier): 1. Buy UPS for each till 2. Get faster internet 3. Train cashiers on scanning

From L. Dlamini (Cashier): 4. Install inverter for whole shop 5. Use LTE backup when fibre slow

From P. Khumalo (Admin): 6. Upgrade admin PCs from 4GB to 8GB RAM + SSD 7. Install cloud backup for Pastel

From S. Ncube (Stock): 8. Buy handheld barcode scanner for stock take 9. Do daily stock count 10. Lock stock room

From [Your Name]: 11. Put password on WiFi to stop customers using it 12. Implement WhatsApp ordering to reduce queue 13. Install self-service kiosk long-term

Total Ideas: 13 ideas

After evaluation, top 4 selected by voting:

1. Buy 6 UPS + 3kVA inverter + battery - R30,000 (Votes: 5)

2. Upgrade internet to 100Mbps + LTE auto failover - R1,500/month (Votes: 5)

3. Upgrade 2 admin PCs to 8GB RAM + SSD - R12,000 (Votes: 4)

4. Provide advanced training + cloud backup - R5,000 (Votes: 4)

Central: Store Problems

Branch 1: Power - Load shedding - No UPS - Loss R5k - Solution: UPS/Inverter

Branch 2: Internet - Slow peak - Freezing tills - Solution: 100Mbps + LTE

Branch 3: Stock - Discrepancy - 5 units missing - Solution: Handheld scanner + daily count + training

b)

RESEARCH REPORT – By Precious Fikile Mkhize Presented 13 September 2026

Task: Research UPS/Inverter prices and internet packages.

Research Done:

1. UPS and Inverter:

- Called 3 suppliers: Takealot, Makro, Matrix Warehouse.
- Best option: 6 x 1200VA UPS @ R1,500 each = R9,000 (for each till, 30 mins backup)
- 1 x 3kVA Inverter + 2 x 200Ah batteries = R21,000 (for server + lights, 4 hours backup)
- Total: R30,000 - Warranty 1 year.
- Supplier: Matrix Warehouse - includes installation.

2. Internet Upgrade:

- Current: Telkom 50Mbps @ R1,199 - speed drops to 5Mbps at peak.
- Research: Telkom 100Mbps @ R1,499/month, Afrihost 100Mbps @ R1,399/month with free LTE failover router.
- Recommendation: Afrihost 100Mbps - faster and cheaper, auto switches to LTE when fibre slow.

3. Cloud Backup:

- Research: OneDrive 1TB @ R199/month, Google Drive 2TB @ R299/month.
- Pastel data is 50GB, OneDrive enough.
- Recommendation: OneDrive @ R199/month - daily automatic backup.

Presentation: I presented on flip chart with price table. Team evaluated information:

- Team agreed UPS + inverter is affordable vs losing R5k per load shedding.
- Team agreed Afrihost internet is best - faster + LTE backup.
- Team agreed OneDrive is cheapest for backup.

Evaluation criteria used: Cost, feasibility, time to implement, impact.

c) TEAM'S FINAL DECISION REPORT

Date: 14 September 2026

Meeting: Final Decision Meeting - All 5 members present

After brainstorming and research, team evaluated all solutions using decision matrix (Cost vs Impact).

Final Decision:

The team decided to recommend to management the following 3 priority solutions to be implemented immediately:

Priority 1 (Immediate - within 2 weeks):

Purchase and install 6 x UPS for tills and 1 x 3kVA Inverter + batteries for server.

Cost: R30,000 one-time. Benefit: Prevents closure during load shedding, saves R5,000 per day.

Supplier: Matrix Warehouse.

Priority 2 (Within 1 month):

Upgrade internet from 50Mbps to 100Mbps with Afrihost including LTE auto failover router.

Cost: R1,399 per month (only R200 more than current). Benefit: Stops tills freezing, faster checkout.

Priority 3 (Within 2 months):

Upgrade 2 admin PCs to 8GB RAM + 256GB SSD and implement OneDrive cloud backup + provide advanced training for admin and cashiers.

Cost: R12,000 for PCs + R199/month for OneDrive + R5,000 training.

Benefit: Pastel runs faster, data safe, staff more skilled.

Long-term recommendation: Consider self-service kiosk and WhatsApp ordering system in 2027 budget.

Decision reached by: Consensus for Priority 1 and 2 (all agreed), Majority vote 4-1 for Priority 3.

Implementation Plan:

- Week 1-2: Buy UPS/Inverter

- Week 3-4: Upgrade internet

- Week 5-8: Upgrade PCs and training

Team Signatures:

1. Precious Fikile Mkhize – Coordinator _____

2. P. Khumalo - Scribe _____

3. S. Ncube - Timekeeper _____

4. T. Nkosi - Member _____

5. L. Dlamini - Member _____

Supervisor Approval: N. Dlamini _____

Date: 14/09/2026